

Plant providers

Is your table made from wood, or are your clothes made from cotton? Plants provide us with lots of everyday items, from the houses in which we live to the pages of this book.



Spin a yarn

Linen is made from a plant called flax, one of the first plants grown by people just to be used. Flax fibres are spun to make threads, which are woven into material.



Bamboo bounty

Bamboo is possibly the most useful plant of all, and is especially popular in Asia. Its strong, tube-shaped stems have dozens of uses, from furniture and water pipes to hats.

Use it all up

This entire house has been made from palm trees. The trunk gives timber for the frame and walls, and the leaves are used as thatch.

Palm fruit, coconut, is also used for food, milk, and oil. Even the hair on the coconut shell is turned into mats.



On a roll

Imagine a world with no paper. No books, boxes, or even tissues, which are all made from mashed-up wood chips. If you grew a tree to make the amount of paper you used every year, it would be 30 m (100 ft) tall.